



The 2026 Optimist World Championship Tanger, MOROCCO June 18 – 28

ORGANISING AUTHORITY

The 2026 Optimist World Championship is organized by the Royal Yacht Club de Tanger under the authority of the International Optimist Dinghy Association (IODA).

SAILING INSTRUCTIONS

[NP] denotes a rule that shall not be grounds for protests by a boat. This changes RRS 60.1.

[SP] denotes a rule for which a standard penalty may be applied by the race committee or technical committee without a hearing, or a discretionary penalty applied by the international jury with a hearing. This changes RRS 60.5 (b) and RRS A5.1.

1 RULES

- 1.1 The Championship will be governed by the 'rules' as defined in The Racing Rules of Sailing (RRS).
- 1.2 **[SP]** The current Conditions of the IODA will apply.
- 1.3 No national authority prescriptions will apply.
- 1.4 RRS 60.2(a) 1 is changed to 'if the protestor is a boat, she shall hail 'Protest' at the first reasonable opportunity. She shall inform the Race Committee at the finishing line immediately after finishing of the boats being protested, or as soon as practicable after she retires.'
- 1.5 **[SP]** RRS 40.1 applies at all times while afloat. The personal flotation device shall conform to Class Rule 4.2 (a).
- 1.6 RRS 90.3 (e) shall apply.
- 1.7 **[DP]** Competitors and support persons shall comply with any reasonable request from an event official. Failure to comply may be misconduct.

2 **[NP][DP][SP]** CAMERAS AND ELECTRONIC EQUIPMENT

- 2.1 Boats may be required to carry cameras, sound equipment or positioning equipment as specified by the Organising Authority. Information from this equipment shall not be used by a boat as evidence in a hearing. This changes RRS 63.4(b).
- 2.2 The equipment provided, once placed on the boat as instructed by the Organising Authority, shall not be manipulated by the competitor or the coach in any way, except when so required by the Organising Authority.

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- 2.3 Drones are prohibited in the racing area at all times during the championship except those operated by the Organising Authority.
- 2.4 Electronic or mechanical timing devices may include a compass but shall not have any other function / capabilities.

3 COMMUNICATIONS WITH COMPETITORS

- 3.1 Notices to competitors will be posted on the Official Notice Board online located at <http://2026worlds.optiworld.org> and on the event APP. Information can be duplicated on a Whatsapp group created by the OA by invitation. Failure to publish notices on the Whatsapp group will not be grounds for redress. This changes RRS 61.1 (a).
- 3.2 Signals made ashore will be displayed from the official flagpole located **at the slipway**.
- 3.3 **[NP][DP][SP]** Flag D displayed with one sound means: 'the warning signal will be made not less than **60** minutes after flag D is displayed.' Boats shall not leave their berthing places until this signal is made.
- 3.4 On the water, the race committee intends to monitor and communicate with coaches on **VHF radio channel 72**.
- 3.5 **[DP]** From the first warning signal until the end of the last race of the day, except in an emergency, a boat shall not make voice or data transmissions and shall not receive voice or data communication that is not available to all boats.

4 CHANGES TO SAILING INSTRUCTIONS

- 4.1 Any change to the Sailing Instructions will be posted on the Official Notice Board before **10:00** on the day it will take effect, except that any change to the schedule of races will be posted by **20:00** hours on the day before it will take effect.

5 **[DP][SP]** BOATS

- 5.1 Charter boats are not mandatory. Competitors sailing on charter boats shall use the boats according to paragraph 16 of the Notice of Race.
- 5.2 Competitors sailing on charter boats shall report any damage or loss of equipment, however slight, to the Organising Authority's representative and complete a 'request' in the online form in the 'Sailor Account' which is located on the official event microsite at <http://2026worlds.optiworld.org> and on the event APP immediately after securing the boat ashore.
- 5.3 Failure or loss of chartered equipment will not be grounds for a request for redress. This changes RRS 61.1 (a).
- 5.4 Hulls, foils, and daggerboards shall not be cleaned using any substance other than water unless permitted in writing by the technical committee.

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- 5.5 All boats and all items of equipment once measured shall not be removed from the boat park or nautical venue or placed inside the equipment tents without permission of the technical committee.

6 RESERVE

7 FORMAT OF RACING

- 7.1 The Championship will consist of a Qualifying series followed by a Final series.
- 7.2 **Qualifying series:**
- 7.2.1 Boats will be assigned to yellow, blue, red and green fleets on a daily basis.
- 7.2.2 The Qualifying series will take place on the first 3 days of racing, unless 5 races have not been completed by all fleets by the end of the third IWC racing day. Then the Qualifying series will continue until the end of the IWC racing day in which the fifth Qualifying race is completed, and then the qualifying series will include all races sailed until the end of that day. If 5 races are not completed in the qualifying series by the end of the program racing days as described in 8.1, the fleets shall not be divided into gold, silver, bronze or emerald.
- 7.2.3 For the initial assignment boats will be sorted by alphabetical order of national letters and then by numerical order of sail number. Boats in the sorted list will be allocated to fleets according to the pattern shown in the table in instruction 7.2.7. Initial assignments will be made by the race committee and will be posted after the registration has been completed.
- 7.2.4 Boats will be assigned to fleets of, as nearly as possible, equal size.
- 7.2.5 Only to split the fleets, if after application of RRS A8, two or more boats are tied in rank, their relative positions in the rank will follow the order stated in instruction 7.2.3.
- 7.2.6 **[NP][DP]** Boats will be reassigned to fleets after each day of racing, except if on the first day only one race is completed. If all fleets have completed the same number of races, boats will be reassigned on the basis of their ranks in the series. If all fleets have not completed the same number of races, the series scores for reassignment will be calculated for those races, numbered in order of completion, completed by all fleets.
- 7.2.7 Reassignments will be made as follows:

FLEETS

Rank in series	Fleet Assignment
First	Yellow

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Second	Blue
Third	Red
Fourth	Green
Fifth	Green
Sixth	Red
Seventh	Blue
Eighth	Yellow
Ninth	Yellow
And so on	

7.2.8 Fleet Assignments for the Qualifying Series will be based on the ranking available at 21:00 that day regardless of protests or requests for redress not yet decided. If all fleets have not completed the same number of races by the end of the day, the fleets with fewer races will continue racing the following day until all fleets completed the same number of races. All boats will thereafter race in the new fleets.

7.3 Final series:

7.3.1 Boats will be assigned to gold (yellow), silver (blue), bronze (red) and emerald (green) fleets on the basis of their ranks in the Qualifying series. Gold, silver, bronze, and emerald will have as near as possible the same number of competitors. If not possible, gold will have the largest fleet. Boats with the best qualifying series ranks will race all final series races in the gold fleet, silver will follow gold, bronze will follow silver and emerald will follow bronze.

7.3.2 Assignments in the final series will be based on the ranking available at 21:00 the day before regardless of protests or requests for redress except that a redress decision may promote a boat to a higher fleet.

7.3.3 Any recalculation of the qualifying series ranking after the boats have been assigned to final series fleets will not affect the assignments, except that a redress decision may promote a boat to a higher fleet.

7.4 [NP][DP] Boats shall display a coloured ribbon corresponding to the colour of her fleet, permanently fixed during the day's races and flying from the top of the sprit, unless SI 7.2.8 applies. The ribbons will be provided by the Race Office.

8 SCHEDULE OF RACES

8.1 Program:

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Thursday, June 18	Official Arrival Day. Registration and Measurement. Official accommodation available from 1400.
Friday, June 19	Registration and Measurement. Team Leaders' meeting. Opening Ceremony
Saturday, June 20	IWC Races.
Sunday, June 21	IWC Races.
Monday, June 22	IWC Races.
Tuesday, June 23	TRWC
Wednesday, June 24	TRWC
Thursday, June 25	IWC Races Reserve for TRWC
Friday, June 26	IWC Races Reserve for TRWC
Saturday, June 27	IWC Races Reserve for TRWC Closing and Prize Giving Ceremony
Sunday, June 28	Official Departure Day Accommodation provided until 11:00

- 8.2 Twelve races are scheduled. Up to 3 races may be sailed on each day. One extra race per day may be sailed, provided that the change is made according to instruction 4.
- 8.3 The scheduled time of the coaches' meeting each day is **11:00**. Meetings will take place in the **first floor of RYCT**.
- 8.4 The scheduled time of the warning signal for the first race each day is **13:00** hours.
- 8.5 To alert boats that a race or sequence of races will begin soon, the orange flag defining the starboard end of the starting line will be displayed with one sound at least five minutes before a warning signal is displayed.
- 8.6 On the final day of racing, no warning signal will be made after 15:00 hours.

9 CLASS FLAGS

- 9.1 For fleet series: the fleet flags.

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- 9.2 A fleet flag is a flag of the colour of the corresponding fleet as per instruction 7.2.7.
- 9.3 For Final series:
- Gold fleet: Yellow
 - Silver fleet: Blue
 - Bronze fleet: Red
 - Emerald fleet: Green

10 RACING AREA

- 10.1 Attachment 1 shows the location of the racing area.

11 THE COURSE

- 11.1 The diagram in Attachment 2 shows the course, including the order in which marks are to be passed, and the side on which each mark is to be left.

12 MARKS

- 12.1. Mark 1, 2, 3S and 3P will be robotic yellow marks.
- 12.2. The starting and finishing marks will be race committee vessels.
- 12.3. The waiting area windward boundary will be designated by **orange pin** marks defined in 24.1.
- 12.4. Except at a gate, a race committee vessel signaling a change of the leg of the course is a mark as provided in instruction 14.2.
- 12.5. If a gate is missing and has not been replaced with an object displaying flag M, the remaining mark shall be rounded to port.

13 THE START

- 13.1. The starting line will be between staffs displaying orange flags on the starting marks.
- 13.2. **[NP][DP][SP]** When the warning signal for the first fleet has been made, boats from the other fleets shall be in or downward of the waiting area. Boats starting next may approach the starting line after the start of the previous fleet.
- 13.3. **[DP][SP]** Boats that have finished shall return directly to the waiting area or ashore, keeping well clear of all boats racing and of all boats whose warning signal has been made.
- 13.4. A boat starting later than 2 minutes after her starting signal will be scored Did Not Start without a hearing. This changes RRS A5.1 and A5.2.
- 13.5. The starting order of the fleets will be Yellow, Blue, Red and Green for all races in the Qualifying series and Gold, Silver, Bronze and Emerald for all races in the Final series.

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14 CHANGE OF NEXT LEG OF THE COURSE

- 14.1. A change of the next leg of the course will be made as in RRS 33.
- 14.2. The Original Marks will be moved to the new position.
- 14.3. Any action or no action by the race committee under this instruction SI 14 will not be grounds for redress under RRS 62.1(a).
- 14.4. The RC may make minor adjustments (up to 10 degrees and .1NM in length) to the course during a race without signaling a course change, provided the change is made before any boats begin that leg. This changes RRS 33.
- 14.5. Except at a gate, boats shall pass between the race committee vessel signaling the change of course and the nearby mark, leaving the mark to port and the race committee vessel to starboard. This changes RRS 28.

15 THE FINISH

- 15.1 The finishing line will be between staffs displaying blue flags on the finishing marks.

16 PENALTY SYSTEM

- 16.1 **[NP][DP]** A boat that has taken a penalty or retired according to RRS 44.1 shall complete the online form in the "Sailor Account" located on the official event microsite <http://2026worlds.optiworld.org> and the event APP within the protest time limit.
- 16.2 The penalty for breaches of Class Rules will be Standard Penalties **[SP]**, which changes RRS 60.5 (b) and A5.1 and may also be less than disqualification.
- 16.3 Appendix P will apply.

17 TIME LIMITS AND TARGET TIMES

- 17.1 Time limits and target times are as follow:

TIME LIMIT	MARK 1 TIME LIMIT	TARGET TIME
90 minutes	30 minutes	50 minutes

- 17.2 If no boat has passed Mark 1 within the Mark 1 time limit the race will be abandoned. Failure to meet the target time will not be grounds for redress. This changes RRS 61.1 (a).
- 17.3 Boats failing to finish within 20 minutes after the first boat sails the course and finishes will be scored Did Not Finish without hearing. This changes RRS 35, A5.1 and A5.2.

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18 HEARING REQUESTS

- 18.1 To inform the Race Committee of the boat/s being protested as required by instruction 1.4, the boat intending to protest shall approach the starboard side of the race committee vessel at the starboard end of the finishing line immediately after finishing and shall hail the protested boat's sail number/s and have received acknowledgement.
- 18.2 Hearing Request forms are available online in the "Sailor Account" located on the official event microsite <http://2026worlds.optiworld.org> and on the event APP. Protests and requests for redress or reopening shall be delivered there within the appropriate time limit. If the online system is not operational, contact the Jury to receive permission to lodge the request via email. This changes RRS 60.3, 61.2 and 63.7.
- 18.3 The protest time limit is 60 minutes after the last boat has finished the last race of the day or the Race Committee signal no more racing today, whichever is later.
- 18.4 Notices will be posted within 30 minutes of the protest time limit to inform competitors of hearings in which they are parties or named as witnesses. Hearings will be held in the Protest Hearing Rooms located on the **ground floor of RYCT**. No hearing will start after 21:00 hours.
- 18.5 A list of boats that under instruction 16.3 have been penalized for breaking RRS 42 will be posted.
- 18.6 For the purpose of measurement protests as per RRS 63.5(d), the 'authority responsible' is the technical committee representative.
- 18.7 Decisions of the jury are final as provided in RRS 70.3 (a). If Appendix N1.4 (b) applies, the time limit for request for a full panel hearing by a full international jury is 15 minutes after the parties have been informed of the decision.

19 SCORING

- 19.1 Race scores instructions 19.1.1, 19.1.2 and 19.1.3 apply only when boats sail in separate fleets. Instruction 19.1.3 applies only to the qualifying series.
 - 19.1.1 For the Qualifying Series, RRS A.5.2 is changed so that those scores are based on the number of boats assigned to the largest fleet.
 - 19.1.2 Final Series fleets will be scored separately. Different final series fleets need not have completed the same number of final races. RRS A5.2 is changed so that those scores are based on the number of boats assigned to the given fleet.
 - 19.1.3 If at the end of the last day of races some boats have more race scores than others, scores for the most recent races will be excluded so that

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- all boats have the same number of race scores.
- 19.2 Three races are required to be completed to constitute a valid championship.
 - 19.3 When fewer than 5 races have been completed, a boat's series score will be the total of her race scores.
 - 19.4 When 5 or more races have been completed, a boat's series score will be the total of her race scores excluding her worst score.
 - 19.5 To request correction of an alleged error in the posted races or series results, a boat shall complete a scoring enquiry form available online in the "Sailor Account" located on the official event microsite at <http://2026worlds.optiworld.org> and on the event APP.
 - 19.6 Once the final series has begun, gold fleet shall rank ahead of silver fleet, silver fleet shall rank ahead of bronze fleet, and bronze fleet shall rank ahead of emerald fleet. However, a boat that is scored DNE in all races shall be ranked in last place OVERALL.

20 **[NP][SP] SAFETY REGULATIONS**

- 20.1 **[SP] Sign-Out and Sign-In Procedure.** The requirements of this instruction are specified for the safety of the competitors.
 - 20.1.1 The control point to Sign-Out and Sign-In competitors will be available online in the 'Coach/Team Leader Account' located on the official event microsite at <http://2026worlds.optiworld.org> and on the event APP.
 - 20.1.2 The team leader or coach of each country shall individually Sign-Out each competitor on their team each day before racing, beginning two hours before the scheduled warning for the day, by marking the box beside the name of each of the competitors on their team that will be leaving the venue to race.
 - 20.1.3 The team Leader or coach of each country shall individually Sign-In each competitor on their own team each day after racing immediately upon returning to shore but no later than the protest time limit, by marking the box beside the name of each of the competitors on their team that have returned to the venue after racing,
 - 20.1.4 Each competitor is individually responsible for his team leader or coach to comply with instruction 20.1.2. A standard penalty of one point in the first race of the day shall be imposed without hearing on competitors for failure to comply with instruction 20.1.2. This changes RRS 60.5 (b).
 - 20.1.5 Each competitor is individually responsible for his team leader or coach to comply with instruction 20.1.3. A standard penalty of one point in the last race of the day shall be imposed without a hearing on competitors for failure to comply with instruction 20.1.3. This changes RRS 60.5 (b).

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- 20.2 **[DP]** A boat retiring from a race shall notify a race committee or safety vessel before leaving the course and shall complete the relevant form online in the “Sailor Account” located on the official event microsite <http://2026worlds.optiworld.org> and on the event APP within the protest time limit.
- 20.3 **[DP]** Each day of competition the coach or team leader shall notify the Race Office before D flag is displayed of the boats not intending to race that day by completing the relevant form online in the “Sailor Account” located on the official event microsite <http://2026worlds.optiworld.org> and on the event APP.
- 20.4 Competitors who require assistance shall blow a whistle or wave the paddle or one arm. The race committee reserves the right to assist competitors who in their opinion require assistance, regardless of the wishes of the competitor. This will not be grounds for redress. This changes RRS 61.1 (a).
- 20.5 When the race committee displays V flag with repetitive sounds, all official and support vessels shall monitor the race committee **VHF channel 72** for search and rescue instructions.
- 20.6 **[DP]** If a boat is abandoned, it shall be marked with coloured hazard tape tied through the bow eye to signal that the sailor is safe. The hazard tape is provided by the Organising Committee and shall be collected by the coaches at the Race Office.

21 [DP[SP]] REPAIR OR SUBSTITUTION OF EQUIPMENT

- 21.1 Substitution of damaged or lost equipment will not be allowed unless approved in writing by the technical committee. Requests for substitution shall be requested as soon as possible using the relevant forms online in the ‘Sailor Account’ which is located on the official event microsite <http://2026worlds.optiworld.org> and on the event APP. Both the damaged and the substituting equipment shall be presented for inspection to the technical committee at the first reasonable opportunity before the event protest time limit on the respective day. The technical committee shall extend the time if there is good reason to do so.
- 21.2 Substitution of damaged equipment may be permitted provided that the relevant form has been completed online in the “Sailor Account” located on the official event microsite <http://2026worlds.optiworld.org> and on the event APP, and both the damaged and the substituting equipment has been checked by the technical committee.
- 21.3 If the substitution was made on the water between races, both the damaged and the substituting equipment shall be presented to the technical committee after the end of the day’s racing. The substitution is subject to the approval of the technical committee given retrospectively and the form shall be completed as

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per 21.2 above.

22 [NP][DP][SP] EQUIPMENT AND MEASUREMENT CHECKS

- 22.1 A boat or equipment may be inspected at any time for compliance with the Class Rules, the Notice of Race or the Sailing Instructions. All finishing boats of every race are requested to sail to the vicinity of the Equipment Inspector vessel located near the finishing line. No adjustments shall be made on the boat before the measurement inspection.
- 22.2 All equipment measured during the measurement days may be scrutineered again during the championship.

23 OFFICIAL AND ACCREDITED VESSELS

- 23.1 Official vessels will be identified as follows:

VESSEL	FLAG
Race Committee Signal Vessel	Orange Flag with RC
Race Committee Vessels	Orange Flag with RC
Jury Vessels	Black Flag with Jury
Rescue Vessels	Orange Flag with Safety
Equipment Inspector Vessel	Black Flag with M
Support Vessels	Green Flag with Numbers

- 23.2 Accredited Vessels will be identified as follows:

Press	White Flag with Press
Spectators and VIP Vessels	VIP Flag

24 [DP][SP] SUPPORT VESSELS

- 24.1 **[NP]** Support Vessel's location while afloat:
- 24.1.1 From the time of the warning signal for the first fleet to start, until all boats in all fleets are no longer racing, support vessels shall stay outside areas where boats are or will be racing as defined in Attachment 2 and shall not be closer than 100m to any boat racing. They may go to windward by motoring outside the port side of the course and shall avoid the restricted

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- area indicated in Attachment 2.
- 24.1.2 When in the starting area, support vessels shall remain in the waiting area from the first warning signal of a race, until the last fleet of that race has started. However, they may abandon the waiting area temporarily to serve their competitors after a fleet has started, been postponed, or abandoned, until the warning signal of the next fleet to start is made. Note that the limitations in instruction 24.1.1 always apply.
 - 24.1.3 Support vessels may motor from the finishing area to the waiting area through the center channel (See Attachment 2). They shall motor in such a way to minimize the effect their wash will have on boats racing. Note that the limitations in instruction 24.1.1 always apply.
 - 24.1.4 When a race committee or jury member indicates a support vessel to move further from the course area, the mentioned vessel shall do so immediately.
 - 24.1.5 If flag V (instruction 20.5) is displayed on the Race Committee signal vessel, support vessels shall follow instructions of the Race Committee and these over-ride any conflicting rules with SI 24.1.
 - 24.2 All boats associated with the infringing support vessel may be penalized at the discretion of the jury for the race on which the support personnel failed to comply with Notice of race 15 and/or with this instruction. This changes RRS 62. 4.
 - 24.3 **[NP]** Competitors shall not approach any vessel other than an official vessel (see instruction 23) from their first warning signal of the day until they finish their last race for the day, or the race committee signal no more racing today, whichever is later.
 - 24.4 Coaches are encouraged to carry a working VHF radio.
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- 25 TRASH DISPOSAL**
- 25.1 Trash may be placed aboard support and race committee vessels.
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- 26 [NP][DP] BERTHING**
- 26.1 Boats shall be kept in their assigned places in the boat park.
-
- 27 PRIZES**
- 27.1 Prizes will be awarded in accordance with the Notice of Race.
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- 28 RISK STATEMENT**
- 28.1 RRS 3 states: "The responsibility for a boat's decision to participate in a race or to continue to race is hers alone." By participating in this event each competitor and the responsible adult agrees and acknowledges that sailing is a potentially

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dangerous activity with inherent risks. These risks include strong winds and rough seas, sudden changes in weather, failure of equipment, boat handling errors, poor seamanship by other boats, loss of balance on an unstable platform and fatigue resulting in increased risk of injury. **Inherent in the sport of sailing is the risk of permanent, catastrophic injury or death by drowning, trauma, hypothermia, or other causes.**

29 [NP] INSURANCE

- 29.1 The purchase of third-party liability event insurance from IODA is mandatory. The purchase will be arranged through the IODA at a cost of EURO 12 per competitor and per coach, payable to the IODA before registration is completed. Details of this insurance can be found at:
http://www.optiworld.org/uploaded_files/thirdParty.pdf_1948_en.pdf
There is a Euro 150 deductible payable on any claim.

30 RIGHT TO USE NAMES AND LIKENESS

- 30.1 In participating in this championship, a competitor automatically grants to the Organising Authority, the IODA and the sponsors of the championship the right in perpetuity to make, use and show at their discretion any motion pictures, still pictures and live, taped or filmed television and other reproductions of him or her during the championship, and of all of his or her material related to the championship, without compensation.

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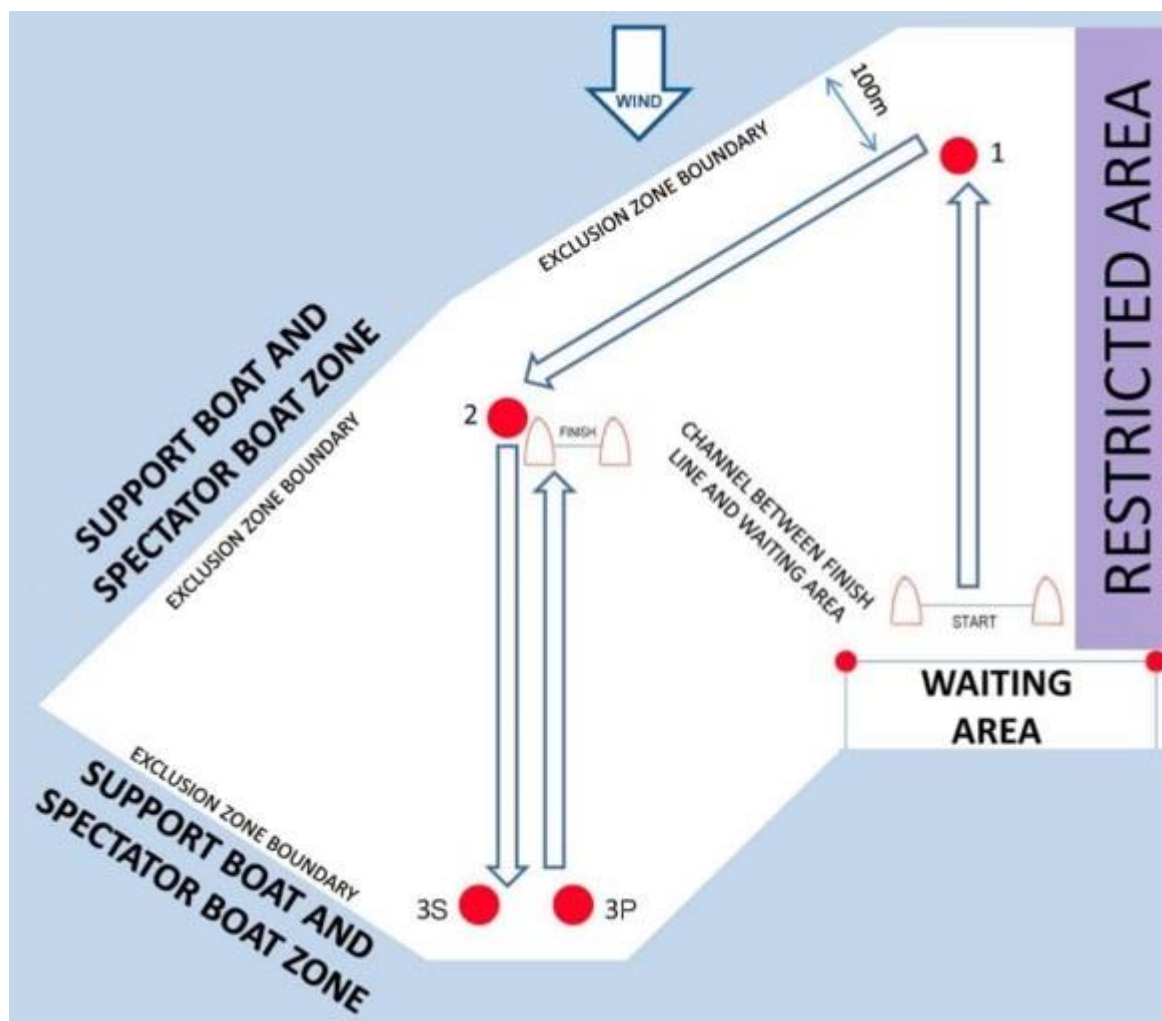
ATTACHMENT 1: RACING AREA



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ATTACHMENT 2: THE COURSE



COURSE: START - 1 (PORT) - 2 (PORT) - 3 S/3 P (GATE) – FINISH

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ATTACHMENT 3: VENUE MAP

